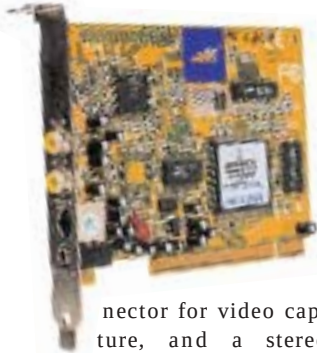


Monarch MV5

Capture it!

The MV-5 kit consists of a PCI Video capture card and the MV5 software that is used to capture the video stream. The PCI capture card has two RCA video-in jacks and one S-video con-



connector for video capture, and a stereo Audio-in mini-jack for audio capture. The kit also bundles an RCA video cable for connecting the card to a video source and an RCA to mini-jack cable for connecting the card to the audio source. Monarch has also provided Ulead Video Studio 6.0, Ulead DVD Movie Factory

Price: Rs 9,500
Contact: Monarch Video Vision
Phone: 022-22619022
Fax: 022-22618706
E-mail: viren@bom2.vsnl.net.in
Web site: www.monarchvision.com

and Flip album 5.0. The conversion process couldn't be simpler—you just need to connect the audio and video outputs of the VCR to the input of the capture card, and the MV5 software takes care of the rest. The interface is simple to use and understand. A playback window is integrated in the software interface and shows the playback from the VCR. Select the proper parameters for your VCD, and click on Record to start the capturing process. The software also allows you to define the recording time duration, so that you can split the file into multiple VCDs. Priced at Rs 9,500, it offers good value for money.

SPECIFICATIONS

Output file In MPEG, 64 to 6 Mbps video bit rate, two RCA jacks for composite input, one S-video and one 3.5 mm stereo audio jack

Monarch MV5
Performance
Features
Ease of use
Value for money

Ulead MediaStudio Pro 7

Feature rich movie maker

The new Ulead MediaStudio Pro 7 for audio and video editing consists of multiple components, the most important of these is the Video Editor, a complete non-linear video editing tool. Each individual application has a Switch menu that helps in toggling between them, but this can be cumbersome, as each has to be invoked separately.



While the documentation mentions support for Quick-Time files, it was not possible to use them in any operation. Pro 7 adds a new meaning to fast real-time previewing and on the fly video editing. Even if you don't have realtime enabled hardware, you can use the on-the-fly editing and rendering features; we recommend RT hardware. The DVD authoring tools have been completely revamped in this new release of MediaStudio by replacing the DVDPlugin with

DVD-VR Wizard and DVD Movie Factory (Light Edition). It crashed miserably on one of our three test beds—a Pentium 4 (2.8 GHz) 512 MB RAM, GeForce3 (64 MB) running Windows XP—but ran perfectly well on the other two. While Pro 7 is SMP enabled, no significant performance gain was observed on the Dual Xeon test bed. Another unique feature is the support for Sony MICROMV format. Overall, Ulead Media Studio Pro 7 is an excellent
Price: Rs 27,500
Contact: Micrographics
Phone: 011-22092423
E-mail: micrographics@vsnl.com
Web site: www.asiapac.ulead.com

Sony ATRAC CD Walkman D-NE511

Music wherever you go

The Sony D-NE511 is a portable CD player that supports playback of audio CDs, MP3 and the proprietary ATRAC3 or ATRAC3plus formats. It sports a four-way navigation and playback key, a jog dial, four keys to control various functions and an open button for the lid. The LCD displays the track ID3 information, battery status, file number, etc. Use the bundled SonicStage Simple Burner software to convert audio CDs or MP3 tracks to ATRAC3plus or ATRAC3 formats. We were able to accommodate about 275 assorted tracks on a standard 700 MB CD-RW using ATRAC3plus at 64 Kbps. The device supports m3u playlists
Price: Rs 7,990
Contact: Sony India Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 011-26959990
Fax: 011-26959141
E-mail: mktginfo@sid.in
sony.com.sg
Web site: www.sony.net/walkman



product but lost crucial points due to its tendency to crash on some of the test benches.
SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS
Intel Pentium III 500 MHz, Windows 98 SE, 2000, ME, 2000, XP, 128 MB RAM (256 MB or higher recommended), 300 MB free disk space, 4 GB disk space for DVD capture, CD or DVD-ROM drive, 1024 x 768 display card, Windows-compatible sound card.

Ulead MediaStudio Pro 7
Performance
Features
Value for money
Ease of use

burnt on to MP3 CDs. It has a two-level G- Protection function—one for normal use and the other enhanced level for use while jogging and exercising. This can be controlled from a small switch under the lid of the player. The device is powered using two AA batteries. The audio quality is excellent. However, at Rs 8,000, the device seems a little overpriced.

SPECIFICATIONS

Compact disc digital audio system, Supported formats: Audio CD, ATRAC3, ATRAC3plus, MP3, Frequency response: 20 Hz to 20 KHz, Output: Approximately 5 mW at 16 ohms, Dimensions (WxHxD): 136 x 26.3 x 156.3 mm, Weight: 202 gms

Sony ATRAC CD Walkman D-NE511
Performance
Features
Ease of use
Value for money